



Laundry Without Ruining Your Clothes

Independent Living • sorting, settings, and clothing care

FOR STAFF • 30-MINUTE SESSION

Purpose: Practice sorting loads, reading simple care directions, and choosing washer/dryer settings.

Materials: Packet.

Easy flow: 5 min sort • 15 min scenarios • 5 min sequence • 5 min reflection.

Sort the Load

White T-shirt: ☐ Lights/Whites ☐ Darks ☐ Wash separately first

Black jeans: ☐ Lights/Whites ☐ Darks ☐ Wash separately first

Red hoodie: ☐ Lights/Whites ☐ Darks ☐ Wash separately first

White socks: ☐ Lights/Whites ☐ Darks ☐ Wash separately first

Dark work pants: ☐ Lights/Whites ☐ Darks ☐ Wash separately first

Light towel: ☐ Lights/Whites ☐ Darks ☐ Wash separately first

New bright-red shirt: ☐ Lights/Whites ☐ Darks ☐ Wash separately first

Black sweatshirt: ☐ Lights/Whites ☐ Darks ☐ Wash separately first

Care Label Translator

Machine wash cold → Use cold water in washer.

Tumble dry low → Use low heat in dryer.

Do not bleach → Do not add chlorine bleach.

Hang dry → Do not put in dryer; hang to dry.

Laundry Problems

A new red shirt is mixed with white socks.

What could happen? _____

Better choice: _____

You leave wet clothes in the washer overnight.

What could happen? _____

Better choice: _____

The label says 'tumble dry low' but you use high heat.

What could happen? _____

Better choice: _____

You put too much detergent in the washer.

What could happen? _____

Better choice: _____

Get Them Talking

- What laundry mistake costs the most money?
- How could you remember to move clothes to the dryer?
- What work clothes would you need clean first?